The GitLab Handbook

GitLab Handbook

People Policies

GitLab's People policies support all GitLab team members and ensures their safe and thriving work environment.

Tags: Security_policy Security_policy_ps

> ## This is a Controlled Document
>
> **In line with GitLab's regulatory obligations, changes to controlled documents must be approved or merged by a code owner. All contributions are welcome and encouraged.**

Visibility: Audit

Purpose

All of the policies listed below are important for GitLab team members to read and understand as they deal with people benefits, entity specific issues, and procedures and requirements of the company. If you have any questions around the internal policies, please reach out to People Operations via Compass.

Scope

These policies apply to all GitLab team members, contractors, advisors, and contracted parties interacting with GitLab computing resources and accessing company or customer data.

Roles and Responsibilities

Role	Responsibility
GitLab Team Members	Responsible for following the requirements in these policies
PeopleOps	Responsible for implementing and executing these policies
Legal & PeopleOps Management (Code Owners)	Responsible for approving significant changes and exceptions to these policies

Translations

There are translations available of many of our policies, for reference purposes, currently in Dutch, French, German and Spanish, with further additions planned. They can be accessed here.

General Employment Practices

Open Door Policy

We encourage communication between team members at all levels of the organization. This is an important part of our culture. Whenever problems or concerns arise, it is expected that they will be addressed as quickly as possible. Your immediate manager is the person on the management team who is closest to you and your work. When you need help or have questions, concerns, problems, or suggestions, please contact your manager first. It is your manager's responsibility to assist you - so please ask, and be willing to work the issue out with your manager. They are interested in your success, the success of every team member in their department, and the overall success of GitLab.

If your manager cannot help you or answer your questions, your questions will be referred to someone who can. If you feel your particular question, concern, or suggestion cannot be discussed with your manager, you are encouraged to contact your manager's manager, your assigned People Business Partner or Team Member Relations. It is important to remember that a team member who takes these steps will not be subject to retaliation. You can expect to be treated fairly and with respect.

Romantic and Family Relationships at Work

Hiring Significant Others or Family Members

GitLab is committed to a policy of opportunities based on **qualifications and merit** and does not discriminate in favor of or in opposition to the employment or affiliation of significant others or family members. Due to the potential for perceived or actual conflicts, such as favoritism or personal conflicts from outside the work environment, which can be carried into the daily working relationship, GitLab will hire or consider for hire significant others and/or family members of persons currently serving as team members only if **all** points below are true:

- Candidates for open roles or current team members will not be working directly for or supervising a significant other or family member.
- Candidates for open roles or current team members will not occupy a position in the same line of authority in which team members can initiate or participate in decisions involving a direct benefit to the significant other or family member. Such decisions include hiring, retention, transfer, promotion, wages, talent assessment, and leave requests.
- The team member does not have access to sensitive company and/or personal information including payroll, compensation, personnel reviews/files, job performance, etc., unless the team member's job duties require access to such information. If the position in question requires access to such information, the team member in that position shall comply with the duty to maintain confidentiality as governed by applicable law and policy, and must seek approval from the team member's direct manager for any decisions affecting the significant other or family member's personnel information.

This policy applies to all current team members and candidates for open roles. In the spirit of our Transparency value, we ask the team member and the candidate to disclose the family relationship to the recruiter at the beginning of the hiring process. For purposes of this policy, a significant other or family member is any person who has a relation by blood, marriage, adoption, or domestic partnership within the third degree of our team member. If the candidate progresses through the process as a final candidate, and prior to any offer, the recruiter should notify the hiring manager and the People Business Partner of the family relationship to ensure there is not a conflict of interest. In addition, the GitLab team member should not be part of their family member's interview process. If there is a concern that either the team member or the candidate may progress to a position that would trigger one of the conditions above, a waiver will be signed by both parties acknowledging that future work assignments, promotions, etc may be impacted by enforcement of this policy.

Active Team Member Relationships (Significant Other or Family Members)

Please report any relationship with a significant other or family member to your People Business Partner, if you find yourself in a reporting relationship with the significant other or family member. Furthermore, if two team members who are in a reporting relationship become significant others or family members in the course of their employment, they should also report

the relationship to the People Business Partner. Transfers, promotions, and future work assignments will be made in accordance with all applicable anti-discrimination laws and policies.

Global Accessibility and Accommodations Policy

Global Accessibility Definition

Accessibility refers to the design of environments, systems, products, and services so that they can be used by all people — regardless of disability or difference — without the need for adaptation.

Standard Equipment and Accommodations Framework

Standard Equipment: Available to all team members. This includes ergonomic equipment, adjustable desks, and a standard home office setup accessed through regular processes and budgets. Individualized workplace modifications beyond standard equipment offerings may be provided as a reasonable accommodation/adjustment (see definition below) in accordance with applicable law.

Global Reasonable Accommodation/Adjustment Definition

A reasonable accommodation (or reasonable adjustment) refers to any change or modification made to the work environment, job duties, or application process that enables a qualified individual with a disability to perform the essential functions of their job.

These accommodations are implemented unless they would:

- Create an undue hardship or disproportionate burden for the company
- Pose a direct threat to health or safety
- Conflict with local legal requirements

Note: Specific legal standards for reasonableness vary by country. Please consult with your Team Member Relations Partner for any country-specific queries.

Global Undue Hardship Definition

An accommodation request would create an undue hardship (or disproportionate burden) if it would:

- Require significant difficulty or expense that is disproportionate to GitLab's available resources
- Significantly change the core way we operate as a remote-first organization
- Create legal challenges that are extremely difficult to manage across multiple countries and jurisdictions

This assessment is made through a partnership between the team member, their manager, People Business Partners, Team Member Relations, and Legal, considering the specific essential functions of the role and departmental context.

Team Members Requesting Accommodations

Please submit your request for an accommodation by submitting a ticket in Compass. Your answers will be viewed only by the Team Member Relations Team (TMR), and only the requested accommodation(s) will be shared with your Manager/PBP as needed.

Team Members are under no obligation to provide GitLab with a diagnosis, but you may be asked questions related to how your condition impacts your ability to perform the essential functions of your job, in accordance with applicable law. The TMR will provide you with any necessary paperwork, and assist you with your request.

Equipment Procurement: Any specialized equipment or technology beyond GitLab's standard offerings requires pre-approval before purchase. Equipment purchased without prior approval may not be reimbursed. All requests can be submitted by opening an Accommodations ticket via Compass.

- U.S. Specific Policy

Applicants Requesting Accommodations The Talent Aquisition team should contact the Team Member Relations team (TMR) if a candidate requests an accommodation during the interview process. The TMR team will reach out to the candidate directly if more information is needed. Applicants are under no obligation to provide GitLab with a diagnosis, but you may be asked questions related to how your condition impacts your ability to interview for the role, in accordance with applicable law.

Workplace Conduct

Confidentiality

As stated in the **Confidentiality and Corporate Assets and Corporate Opportunities** section of the Code of Business Conduct and Ethics, team members are, on occasion, entrusted with confidential GitLab information and with the confidential information of GitLab suppliers, customers, or other business partners. This information may include:

1. technical or scientific information about current and future services or research;
2. business or marketing plans or projections;
3. earnings and other internal financial data;
4. personnel information;
5. supply and customer lists; and
6. other non-public information

This information, if disclosed, might be of use to competitors, or harmful to GitLab's suppliers, customers or other business partners. This information is the property of GitLab, or the property of its suppliers, customers, or business partners, and in many cases was developed at great expense. All team members, upon commencement of their role with GitLab, shall sign offer letters or contractor agreements that contain confidentiality provisions (the "Confidentiality Agreement") provided by GitLab. Strict adherence to the Confidentiality Agreement is required of each team member.

Team members shall not take for themselves, or for family members, or any other entities with which they are affiliated, any opportunity of which they become aware through the use of GitLab property or information, or through their position with GitLab, and shall not use GitLab property or information, or their position with GitLab, for personal gain other than actions taken for the overall advancement of the interests of GitLab.

Team members also have obligations to protect the personal and sensitive information of our fellow team members. Therefore, you may not access and/or disseminate any team member's personal information (i.e. address, personal phone number, salary, etc.) that the team member has not made publicly available, unless the team member has provided written permission to share this information. An exception to this restriction would be when access is a necessary function of your job duties. A violation of this obligation is considered severe and could result in disciplinary action, up to and including termination.

Exceptions

Exceptions to the above procedures will be tracked as per the Information Security Policy Exception Management Process.

Anti-Harassment

Please see the Anti-Harassment Policy.

Anti-Retaliation

Please see the Anti-Retaliation Policy.

Complaint Procedure

Please see the Complaint Procedure.

Personal Appearance

The image GitLab projects to the public is reflected in the appearance of our team members. Simply stated, team members should be dressed and groomed appropriately for their specific duties. Team members are expected to use good judgment in their appearance and grooming. Please read our GitLab Events Code of Conduct for more information regarding team member responsibility during attendance at company-sponsored events.

Job Abandonment

When a team member is absent from work for **three consecutive workdays**, there is no entry on the availability calendar for time off, and fails to contact their supervisor, they may be terminated for job abandonment unless otherwise required by law. If a manager is unable to reach a team member via email or Slack within a 24 hour period they should contact their People Business Partner. The People Business partner will access the team member's information to obtain additional contact methods and numbers. The manager and People Business Partner will create an action plan to make all attempts to contact the team member.

Throughout this process, managers and People Business Partners must maintain detailed records of: dates and times of all contact attempts, methods used for each attempt, any responses or information received, consultation with other GitLab teams (if applicable), and jurisdiction-specific considerations.

Exceptions to the Job Abandonment Policy

GitLab understands there are extenuating circumstances that can occur. In the instance that a team member is absent from work for three consecutive workdays due to an emergency outside of the team members' control (see examples below), the recommendation is:

- The team member should notify their manager about the situation, should a period of unavailability be a foreseen possibility.
- The team member and manager should consider exchanging cell phone numbers to stay in contact as much as possible in the case that the situation should escalate. If you are based in different countries, consider ensuring you and your manager both have an app that facilitates international communication (ex. Whatsapp, Zalo, etc.). If costs are incurred when trying to contact your manager, this can be considered a business expense and can be submitted for reimbursement through Navan Expense.
- Consider leveraging GitLab's flexible time off policy to take the time you need.

Examples of Potential Extenuation Circumstances

- Regional internet or telecommunications outages
- Natural disasters or severe weather events
- Sudden medical emergencies affecting the team member or immediate family
- Civil unrest, political instability, or government actions affecting communications
- Technology failures when no alternative communication means are available
- Sudden travel emergencies with no connectivity
- Unexpected legal detention or immigration issues

Team Member Safety

Preventing Unsafe Situations

While GitLab is 100% remote, there may be times when team members travel for work-related functions or co-working events. GitLab is committed to the value of a safe, violence-free work environment and ensuring and exhibiting equal commitment to the safety and health of team members.

In general, please consider the following recommendations to ensure safety when traveling or coworking:

1. Do the research. Have some familiarity with the destination before you arrive. Check with your country's government department that provides advice for traveling overseas:
    - United States: check the State Department's website for country updates and enroll in a Traveler Program such as Smart Traveler Enrollment Program (STEP).
    - New Zealand: Safe Travel.

2. Try not to draw attention. People who appear to be from out of town are more vulnerable to crimes. Try to respect the culture you are visiting by blending in. Consider protective clothing to avoid pickpockets or other theft. Do not flash money or credit cards unnecessarily.
3. Make copies of important documents. Consider carrying hard copies of important documents (passport, driver's license) in a separate location in the event your documents are misplaced or stolen.
4. Keep friends and family updated. No matter whether you're going on an overnight jaunt or a week-long international journey, it's always a good idea to let friends or family know your plans. Before you leave, send a copy of your itinerary to a few trusted people who can keep tabs on your whereabouts. Check in regularly with your contacts so they know you're where you're supposed to be.
5. Be wary of public Wi-Fi. Be aware that hackers can steal sensitive information in the public forum. Use a VPN or other secure access if you plan to access sensitive data. More information on VPN usage at GitLab.
6. Safeguard your hotel. Lock and deadbolt the door while you are in the room. Ensure the door is locked when you leave. Keep the windows closed. Try to give the impression that you're in your room even when you're away, such as placing the Do Not Disturb sign on the outside of your door and keeping the blinds or windows closed. Don't let any strangers into your room, even if they say they work for the hotel. You can always call the front desk to check whether someone was ordered by hotel staff to come to your room.
7. Be aware of your surroundings. Always keep an eye on your personal belongings and use good judgment when talking to strangers. A big part of the joy of traveling is the opportunities it affords to meet new people and learn about their cultures. But if someone near you is acting suspiciously, or if you feel uncomfortable, leave the area immediately. Trust your instincts.
8. Adhere to any recommended safety recommendations made by the GitLab group. For all large self-hosted events we (jointly completed by our internal security team and our contracted security agency) will do a full risk assessment before we converge. It will be up to team members to read said risk assessment and adhere to recommendations outlined.
9. If you are sick please do not come or participate in person workplace activities. This is for your safety and for others. We recommend that GitLab team members not travel while sick.

Responding to Unsafe Situations

The following are GitLab's procedures in the event a team member feels threatened or unsafe:

1. If at any point, a team member feels that they are in danger of physical harm, please contact the local authorities immediately. Local law enforcement can act quickly to protect

the individual and neutralize any threats.

2. If at any point, a team member feels like they or another team member may require immediate medical assistance, please contact the local authorities.
3. Once the immediate threat is controlled, team members should report any safety concerns to People Operations.
4. If you believe that a certain location, event or area presents greater risk or exposure to individuals, please notify People Operations. People Operations will strive to proactively communicate the concerns to other potentially affected team members.
5. If at any point you believe you, personally, may commit an unsafe act, People Operations can assist in providing information about available Modern Health options.

Workers' Compensation

Workers' compensation provides benefits to team members who suffer work-related injuries or illnesses. If you have been injured at work, at a co-working site, or traveling to a customer location please follow our reporting procedures:

- Seek appropriate medical attention immediately for serious injuries. For emergency situations, call local emergency services (911 in the US).
- Report all injuries, regardless of severity, to your manager as soon as possible.
- Contact the Absence Management team through Compass within 24 hours of the injury. The Absence Management team will provide you with paperwork to file your claim and explain your benefits.
- Complete all required documentation as directed by the Absence Management team.

CA Team Members Only: Complete this form and submit to the Absence Management Team in Compass.

The following states are considered "monopolistic" workers compensation states, meaning employers must purchase workers compensation coverage directly from the state. If a team member in these states is injured, they may file the claim themselves or the Absence Management Team will file on their behalf. **Team members in these States are still required to contact the Absence Management Team, even if they file their own claim through the State**:

- Ohio
- Washington
- North Dakota
- Wyoming

Substance Abuse

GitLab strives to maintain a workplace that is free from illegal use, possession, sale, or distribution of alcohol or controlled substances. Legal or illegal substances shall not be used in a manner that impairs a person's performance of assigned tasks. This will help to maintain the efficient and effective operation of the business, and to ensure customers receive the proper service. GitLab team members must also adhere to the local laws of where they reside and where they travel to for company-sponsored events.

Mental Health Awareness Statement

1. Why is awareness of Mental Health important at GitLab?
    - It can affect any and all of us. Statistics indicate that 1 in 4 of us will be affected by mental or neurological disorders at some point in our life. That said, we are all subject to periods where we or those around us find the "the normal stresses of life" harder than usual to deal with.
    - The more we are aware of mental health, the more inclusive we are. That will help encourage any colleagues currently experiencing mental health issues to talk about it.
    - Our business at its core is a group of people working together towards a common goal. With awareness of what might affect our colleagues, we are better equipped to help them if they do discuss it with us and therefore help our business.
    - Mental health has so much emotional baggage as a topic that it can initially seem scary to talk about. Promoting mental health awareness helps to remove the stigma and taboos associated with it.
    - GitLab can offer "productive and fruitful" work for all of our employees. That should not be underestimated.
    - In the cold-light of business metrics, the healthier we are, the more productive we are.
2. At GitLab we strive to create a stigma-free workplace. In accordance with the National Mental Health Association and the National Council for Behavioral Health we would like to:
    - Educate employees about the signs and symptoms of mental health disorders.
    - Encourage employees to talk about stress, workload, family commitments, and other issues.
    - Communicate that mental illnesses are real, common, and treatable.
    - Discourage stigmatizing language, including hurtful labels such as "crazy," "loony" or "nuts."
    - Help employees transition back to work after they take leave.
    - Encourage consultation with our employee assistance programs.

3. What are we doing to get there?
    - Talk about mental health issues and ideas in the #mental_health_aware Slack channel.
    - GitLab would also like to encourage GitLab team members to take time off to properly take care of themselves. We encourage the team to go to yoga, take a long lunch, or anything else in their day to day life that assists in their mental and emotional well-being.
    - In addition to our current EAP programs available for employees, we encourage GitLab team members to take a look at these Resources for Employees for insight into reclaiming well-being at work, off work, and return to work.
    - We believe that our values and culture lends itself to being able to discuss mental health open and honestly without being stigmatized, but let's work together to make it even more inclusive. For example, Finding the right words:
        - "How can we help you do your job?"
        - "You're not your usual self."
        - "Do you want to talk about it?"
        - "It's always OK to ask for help."
        - "It's hard for me to understand exactly what you're going through, but I can see that it's distressing for you."

      For additional information, please see the Mental Wellness Services offered through Modern Health and tips on Leading Through Adversity. Additionally, team members should learn to recognize burnout and to prevent it.

Any questions or concerns? Please feel free to contact the People Operations team via Compass.

Other People Policies

- Backgound Screenings
- Contracts, Background Screenings, Probation Periods, and PIAA
- Outside Employment and Activities
- Paid Time Off
- General Benefits
- Leave of Absence
- Return of Property

GitLab Legal Policies

There are a number of GitLab Legal Policies which are important for GitLab team members to read and understand, and they are listed here.

Entity-Specific Employment Policies

- ▶ GitLab BV (Belgium)
- ▶ GitLab BV (Netherlands)
- ▶ GitLab Canada Corp.
- ▶ GitLab France S.A.S.
- ▶ GitLab GmbH (Germany)
- ▶ GitLab GK (Japan)
- ▶ GitLab Inc. (US)
- ▶ GitLab Ireland LTD
- ▶ GitLab Korea LTD
- ▶ GitLab LTD (UK)
- ▶ GitLab PTY (Australia)

▶ GitLab PTY (New Zealand)

▶ GitLab Singapore PTE LTD

▶ GitLab India Pvt LTD

GitLab France S.A.S. Remote Work Charter

GitLab France S.A.S. Remote Work Charter - French and English language versions.

GitLab France S.A.S. Right to Disconnect Charter

GitLab France S.A.S. Right to Disconnect Charter - French and English language versions.

GitLab India Private Limited EOP Policy

GitLab India's EOP Policy

GitLab India Private Limited Policy Against Sexual Harassment

GitLab India's Prevention of Sexual Harassment Policy

GitLab Ireland Ltd Right to Disconnect Policy

GitLab Ireland Ltd Right to Disconnect Policy

Leave of Absence

GitLab's Company-wide Leave of Absence policies.

People Policies - GitLab Inc (USA)

GitLab's USA-specific People Policies list the mandatory US people-related policies for our US-based team members.

Last modified October 30, 2026: Delete Values page and all it's dependent references (2666725a)

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